

How to Become Unrecognizable Before the Year Ends

EP 318

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 23, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HTqqfsgpDtE> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter argues that with ~5 months left in the year, anyone can radically transform their body, income, and habits by following a disciplined three-part framework: control your body first, learn a money-making skill, then structure every hour of every day.

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Introduction & The 5-Month Opportunity 0:55

- Christmas is roughly 5 months away — enough time to completely reinvent yourself
- What's achievable in 5 months:
 - Lose a substantial amount of fat
 - Start building muscle
 - Launch a business and start making money
 - Double or triple income if you go hard
 - Relocate, switch industries, or learn a valuable skill
- Key insight: people overestimate what they can do in a week but drastically underestimate what they can do in a few months
- Brandon's credentials cited: 27 years training people, helped 15,000+ grow online fitness businesses, multiple personal reinventions

- Focus areas: health and wealth (relationships mostly self-solve once those are handled)
- Also promotes a free live training on August 2nd at 2:00 PM EST on growing an online fitness business using AI — promises \$300–\$500/day extra income, no sales pitch

👊 Pillar 1 — Control the Body (Diet) 1:32

- "If you can't control your own body, how are you going to control the outside world?"
- The case for getting lean FIRST before bulking:
 - Getting ripped makes you look immediately better and actually look bigger due to proportion (hip-to-waist ratio)
 - Example: Michael B. Jordan in Creed — ~6'0", ~180 lbs, looked shredded and massive
 - Example: Brad Pitt in Fight Club — ~5'7"–5'8", ~170 lbs, looked impressive
 - Putting 5 lbs of muscle under fat = nearly unnoticeable; putting 5 lbs of muscle on a lean frame = dramatic
 - Brandon often gets asked "did you get bigger?" after a cut because cuts reveal muscularity
- The Cutting Formula:
 - **Calories:** Body weight in pounds $\times$ 10 = daily calorie target
 - Example: 200 lb person $\rightarrow$ 2,000 calories/day
 - Maintenance estimate: body weight $\times$ 15 (~3,000 for a 200-lb person)
 - You burn more than body weight $\times$ 10 just staying alive, so fat loss is automatic
 - **Protein:** 1 gram per pound of body weight (not lean body mass — full body weight)
 - 300-lb person = 300 grams of protein AND 3,000 calories
 - Why protein is a "cheat code" — the thermic effect of food:

Macronutrient	Calories burned in digestion
Fat	~3%
Carbohydrates	5–15%
Protein	20–30%

- Eating 100 calories of protein means your body only absorbs 70–80 net calories — "like a cashback card, 20–30% back"
 - Fats vs. carbs: Brandon is personally keto (11 years), but is agnostic — adjust the fat/carb split however you like, only calories and protein are non-negotiable
- Optional step to accelerate fat loss: **20,000 steps per day** (~1,000 extra calories burned)
 - Each pound of fat requires burning 3,500 calories total
 - To lose 1 lb/week = 500 calorie deficit $\times$ 7 days = 3,500
 - Why small deficits (500 cal) fail: too easy to miscalculate — a single sauce serving can be 200 calories; estimating restaurant oil is impossible

- Brandon weighs his sauces and condiments when cutting
- The Bulking Formula:
 - Calories: Body weight × 20 (high caloric surplus)
 - Protein: Same (1g per lb body weight)
 - Drop the 20,000 steps
 - That's the only difference: less cardio, twice the calories
- The oscillation method: always either bulking or cutting — never maintenance, never reverse dieting — Brandon has done this exclusively for 20 years
 - Cycle: cut to ~10% body fat → bulk until looking slightly soft → cut again
- Free tool: **Ripped Road Map** at rippedroadmap.com
 - Input height, weight, gender, goal, age, upload a photo
 - AI estimates body fat %, calculates exact macros/calories
 - Provides a week-by-week timeline of expected results
 - Carb/fat slider lets you customize the split

Pillar 1 — Control the Body (Training) 16:07

- Recommendation: **3–4 full body workouts per week**
 - Pick 1–2 exercises per body part
 - Focus on compound movements
 - 3–4 sets per exercise
 - Rest periods: 60–90 seconds between sets (tracked with Apple Watch timer)
- Why full body is superior to splits:
 - Protein synthesis (muscle growth) only lasts ~48 hours
 - Bro splits (1 body part/week) = 5 days of missed muscle growth per muscle group
 - Training every other day keeps you in a near-constant state of protein synthesis
 - Splits were invented for steroid users — steroids extend protein synthesis duration, justifying higher volume per session
 - Brandon has done full body exclusively for 11 years
 - Cites Jeff Nippard as a mainstream voice who also supports this
- Workouts do not take 5 hours if rest periods are timed properly

Why the Body Comes First (Mindset) 28:22

- The physical transformation is really about mental transformation
- Keeping fitness promises to yourself builds self-trust and real confidence
 - "Imagine if someone kept promising to do something and never came through — you'd hate that person. That person is you."

- Keeping small daily commitments compounds into genuine self-respect
- Real confidence vs. fake confidence:
 - Fake confidence requires acting; real confidence just IS
 - You can't fake it past people with real confidence
 - The only way to build it is to give yourself a legitimate reason
- Brandon's personal example: his son bragging to other kids on a Disney cruise about his dad's physique — pride as a motivator beyond vanity
- Inner peace: even Elon Musk's extreme wealth doesn't translate to happiness or peace if you don't like yourself physically/mentally

Pillar 2 — Learn a Skill That Makes Money 33:21

- As an adult, recreation cannot be the priority — you have responsibilities
- You cannot print money; people only give it to you in exchange for valuable goods or services
- Step 1: Pick a skill that can be packaged as a service
 - Examples: sales, copywriting, video editing, running ads, content creation, appointment setting, AI automation, website building, AI integrations for businesses, online fitness training
- Why a **service-based business** over a product-based business (especially for your first venture):

Factor	Service Business	Product Business
Startup cost	Low	High
Overhead	Low	High
Inventory risk	None	Yes (perishable, forecasting)
Failure risk	Low	High
Flexibility	High	Low

- "With a service-based business, if you don't make sales there's no overhead — do better next month."
- Step 2: Start the service-based business built on that skill
- Step 3: Get good at the skill
 - Methods (in order of difficulty/cost):
 - Trial and error (hardest, most punishing)
 - Books, podcasts, YouTube videos (great supplement, never sufficient alone)
 - Paid courses (Brandon buys courses constantly, even from people less successful than him in that domain)
 - Getting a coach or mentor (most important)
 - Mindset for consuming any learning material: "I am going to extract value from this no matter what" — not "I hope this is good"

- Brandon paid \$20,000 for a mastermind with a known scammer, extracted \$20K of value anyway by forcing himself to find it
- Applied same logic to books he found objectively poor — always finds something
- College analogy: if you went 4 years and learned nothing, that's 100% your fault — you chose the school, major, classes, teacher

"Nobody who played in the World Cup learned how to play soccer from podcasts or YouTube videos. Those are supplemental. Nobody relied on that to become a world champion."

- Every high achiever has coaches: Michael Jordan hired Tim Grover (after losses to Detroit Pistons) → 6 championships; Kobe Bryant hired Tim Grover → 5 more rings; Tim also coached Dwyane Wade
- Book recommendation: **Relentless** by Tim Grover (Brandon has it tattooed on his arm)
- Even Luke Skywalker needed Yoda — Hollywood doesn't make the hero figure it out alone because that's not how reality works
- Options: pay a coach (they take it more seriously), internships, working under someone

How to Build the Skill & Get Your First Clients 52:16

- After getting proficient enough, you need **testimonials** before charging clients
- The "Testimonial Harvest" process:
 - Step 1: Post on social media offering to work with people **for free for 1 month** in exchange for a testimonial
 - Step 2: DM everyone you know — followers, friends, contacts
 - Step 3: Go super hard to get them great results (the future of your business depends on it)
 - Step 4: After the month, post testimonials everywhere alongside your content
 - Step 5: Offer those free clients a **founding member discount** (e.g., half price) to continue
 - "If you did a good job, almost all of them will say yes" — these become your first paying clients
 - Aim for at least 5–6 free clients
- Cheat code for fitness coaches: target heavier clients first
 - Fatter people lose weight fastest (body doesn't want to maintain excess mass)
 - Example: one client lost 75 lbs in 75 days (mix of fat + water weight) — did zero exercise initially because he was too heavy; started walking only after losing 100+ lbs
- Testimonials generate new paying clients AND retain existing ones (since 1 month rarely completes a transformation)
- Timeline: you should have your **first paying client in under 90 days** following this process
- In 90 days of diet + training, your body should look "totally different"

- Motivation does not last 6 months — **structure does**
- The goal-planning framework:
 - Set specific targets: exact body fat %, exact income, specific skills to develop
 - Break annual goals into **monthly targets**
 - Break monthly targets into **weekly targets**
 - Break weekly targets into **daily actions**
- The **Victory Vision Planner** (free Notion template — to be linked in description/comments):
 - Each column = one goal (e.g., "Build 100K YouTube subscribers," "100K/month revenue," "10% body fat")
 - Each goal column contains every step needed, with a deadline attached
 - You can filter by: what's due this month, this week, what's not started, what's in progress
 - Steps get placed into Google Calendar by when you'll **do** them (not just their deadline)
- Why written plans with deadlines matter:
 - When Brandon asks people "Do you have a plan?" — fewer than half say it's written down
 - Of those, almost none have it broken into steps with individual deadlines
 - "That's a big reason why most people fail — they don't plan right"

The Time Audit (168-Hour Exercise) 1:09:46

- There are **168 hours in every week** — the exercise is to account for all of them

Activity	Hours/Week
Sleep (8 hrs/night)	56
Work (job)	40
Commute (≤ 1 hr/day)	5
Working out	7
Family/friends time	20
Total accounted	128
Unaccounted / available	40

- **40 hours of unaccounted time every week** — the equivalent of a full-time job available for building your business
 - People without kids or long commutes may have 60–100 hours available
 - Common objections addressed and dismissed:
 - Bathroom time: if it's 40 hrs/week, that's a medical condition
 - Cooking/grocery shopping: do it with your family — counts as family time
 - Kids: middle schoolers and up don't have 20 hrs/week for you; they have school, sports, homework

- The real problem: that 40 hours is currently being spent on:
 - Video games ("World of Minecraft," Call of Duty)
 - OnlyFans
 - Weed sessions with "poor friends"
 - Mindless TV
- "You don't have a time problem. You have a discipline problem."



Calendar Planning & Crowding Out Bad Habits [1:24:48](#)

- **Plan every hour of every day in your calendar** — this is where life actually changes
 - Everyone Brandon knows who does this accomplishes more in the first month than they did in most of the prior year combined
- How to set up the calendar:
 - Step 1: Add all **recurring tasks** first (sleep/wake time, workouts, meals, team meetings)
 - These should be at the same time every day/week
 - Step 2: Review your Victory Vision Planner weekly — pull upcoming action steps
 - Step 3: Place those steps in the **white space** of the calendar (with time estimates)
 - Step 4: Fill all remaining white space with goal-advancing activities
- Brandon's personal calendar includes: meals, workouts, sleep, family time, team meetings — "if I don't care about it, it's not in my calendar"
- The crowding-out effect on bad habits:
 - When your calendar is full, bad habits disappear without willpower or explicit quitting
 - Brandon stopped drinking and using recreational drugs without trying — his calendar was just full
 - "A year went by. I hadn't even thought about it."
- If you follow this entire system:
 - People will be "astonished" by the end of the year — you'll look different, feel different, have a business, make more money, be organized, have eliminated bad habits
 - "It will legitimately be difficult for you to fail"



Super Chat Q&A Highlights [1:30:18](#)

- **On maintaining 9–10% body fat year-round:** Feels great; more noticeable outside Miami (Miami is normalized for fit people); women have grabbed his arm on the NYC subway; most importantly, he's proud of himself
- **On peptides:** Currently taking 5 peptides; remembers tirzepatide at 2.5 (about to lower dose as aggressive cut winds down); planning an experiment at maintenance calories with very high protein (~3,000 cal, 300g protein) for 3 months to study the effect
- **On what to do after making serious money — NBA Accounting:**

- "Never Broke Again" accounting: **invest half of every dollar you make**
- Makes it nearly impossible to go broke; forces you to earn more to fund lifestyle purchases
- Example: want a \$10K Rolex Submariner? You need to earn \$20K first — \$10K for the watch, \$10K invested
- Invested money compounds over time — key to staying and growing rich
- Has a dedicated video: search "NBA accounting Brandon Carter"
- **On networking:** Overrated until you don't need it — that's when it's most valuable
 - Built multiple 6-figure income and 100K YouTube without knowing anyone influential, barely leaving Queens, NY
 - Networking seeking to extract value = not symbiotic; focus on building your own thing first
- **On losing trading days:** If you followed your plan and rules, a loss day is just part of the process — no one has a 100% win rate; rules also limit the size of losses so you're likely still up for the week/month
- **On faceless fitness content (Tik Tok audit):** Reviewed a viewer's faceless TikTok with no captions, Microsoft Word-style graphics — said directly: "There is no version of reality where this will work"; the one video with 14K views was the only one that had any text on screen; recommendation: add captions, show your face — has never seen faceless fitness content succeed at scale
- **On full body vs. push-pull-legs:** Full body, definitively — even mainstream figures like Jeff Nippard and Andrew Huberman now agree
- **Success story shoutout:** Real Coach Low grew 10,000+ IG followers in a few months using Brandon's methods (HTT 2.0) and is getting clients